SEO Changelog — Blog Index (Local Guide)

URL: https://bikkinibottomboat.com/blog/ · **WP ID:** 2048 (set as the WordPress "Posts page"; Elementor + The Post Grid blocks) · **Audit date:** 2026-10-25 · **Audit page 14 of 24**
Sources: WordPress page content, Rank Math fields, category list (site connector), Semrush US keyword data from earlier audits.

> **Limitation:** the live page could not be fetched from the audit environment. Because ID 2048 is the **Posts page** (Settings → Reading), WordPress normally renders it with the theme's blog archive template and **ignores the page's own content**, unless an Elementor Theme Builder archive template overrides it. **VERIFY** what actually shows at /blog/ before acting on §1 row 2.

1. Summary

Area	Current state	Priority
Thin intro	The page's own text is 13 words: H2 "Local Guide and Blog in Destin FL" + "From Bikkini Bottom Boat Charters Crew!". No H1.	**High**
Leftover demo template	The stored content is a **The Post Grid demo layout**: 8 images and a background banner **hot-linked from radiustheme.com** (`ad-landscape-2.jpg`, `ad-portrate-8.png`, `fashion-2-free-banner.jpg`...), demo section titles ("Trending News", "Editor's Picks", "Top News", "Weekly Top News", "What's New") and a 6-icon social-links block. If this renders, the blog shows fashion-magazine demo ads and loads images from a third-party site. If it doesn't render, it's dead weight. Remove it either way.	**High**
Guides are missing from the blog	The 6 Crab Island guides (pages 8–13) are **Pages**, not Posts, so they never appear in the blog listing. Readers of the blog never find them.	**High**
Categories	All 8 posts sit in one category, "Blog", with the default description "Your blog category". "Uncategorized" is empty. There's no topical grouping (Crab Island, things to do, spotlights, events, weather).	**Medium**
Rank Math	Title "Blog | Bikkini Bottom Boat Charters " (trailing space, generic). No focus keyword.	**Medium**
Content gap	"things to do in destin" gets **8,100/mo at KD 15** (Semrush, homepage audit). The site's restaurants post already ranks #7–20 for 1,000–9,900/mo restaurant terms, which shows local-guide content works here. There's no "things to do" pillar post yet.	**High**
Freshness	Page last modified 2025-06-01. Latest post: Hurricane Isaias update (2026).	**Low**

2. Keyword targeting

Keyword	Vol.	KD	Use

things to do in destin	8,100	15	**New pillar post** (not the index). The index H1 references "things to do" and links to it.
destin local guide / destin blog	low	—	Index title + H1
crab island guide	low	—	H2 section linking the 6 guides

3. Rank Math / meta changes

Field	Current	Change to
SEO title	Blog | Bikkini Bottom Boat Charters	**Destin Local Guide: Crab Island Tips, Things to Do & Eats | Bikkini Bottom**. If Rank Math ignores page meta for the Posts page, set it in Titles & Meta → Misc Pages / Blog.
Meta description	Read about local activities and recommendations... There's no better guide than a local!	**Local tips from a Destin boat crew: Crab Island guides, things to do, where to eat, fireworks schedules and local business spotlights.** (136)
Focus keyword	(empty)	**destin local guide**
Page title	Bikkini Bottom Boat Charters Blog and Local Guide	**Destin Local Guide**
Pagination	—	VERIFY that /blog/page/2/ is self-canonical and indexable (Rank Math default). Only 8 posts today, so pagination isn't an issue yet.

4. Page layout & headings

Tag	Current	New
H1	**missing** (H2 "Local Guide and Blog in Destin FL")	**Destin Local Guide from the Bikkini Bottom Crew**
Intro	"From Bikkini Bottom Boat Charters Crew!"	About 80-word intro (see §5)
H2 (new)	—	**Crab Island Guides**: 6 cards linking the guide pages
H2 (new)	—	**Things to Do & Where to Eat in Destin**: post grid filtered to that category
H2 (new)	—	**Local Business Spotlights**: post grid (4 spotlight posts)
H2 (new)	—	**Destin Events, Fireworks & Weather**: post grid
Demo sections	Trending News / Editor's Picks / Top News / Weekly Top News / What's New	**Delete**

CTA (new)	—	Banner: "See Destin from the water. Book a Crab Island tour" → Crab Island page

5. Copy

H1 Destin Local Guide from the Bikkini Bottom Crew

We spend every day on Destin's water, so we know the best times to hit Crab Island, where to eat after your tour, which nights the fireworks fly and which local businesses are worth your time. This guide collects everything we tell our guests: Crab Island how-tos, things to do in Destin, restaurant picks, local spotlights and weather updates.

H2 Crab Island Guides

[Cards] What Is Crab Island? · How Much Does It Cost to Get to Crab Island? · Shuttle vs. Pontoon vs. Charter · What to Bring to Crab Island · Is Crab Island Safe for Families? · Destin Bachelorette Party Boat

H2 Things to Do & Where to Eat in Destin

[Post grid: category "Things to Do"]

H2 Local Business Spotlights

[Post grid: category "Local Spotlights"]

H2 Destin Events, Fireworks & Weather

[Post grid: category "Events & Weather"]

[Book a Crab Island Tour]

6. Category restructure

New category (slug)	Posts to assign	Category description (shown on archive, about 40 words)
Crab Island & Boating (`crab-island`)	2197 Crab Island Excursion Guide; 2244 Crab Island Voyages spotlight (secondary)	"Tips for visiting Crab Island and boating in Destin, from the captains of Bikkini Bottom."
Things to Do in Destin (`things-to-do-destin`)	2210 Best Restaurants; the new "Things to Do in Destin" pillar	"Where to eat, play and explore in Destin, FL, recommended by locals."
Local Spotlights (`local-spotlights`)	2225 Lisa Snuggs Real Estate; 2244 Crab Island Voyages; 2256 Destin Elite Transportation; 2262 A Day Away Massage & Spa	"Meet the Destin-area businesses we love and recommend to our guests."

Events, Fireworks & Weather (`destin-events`)	2192 Destin Fireworks Cruise; 2568 Hurricane Isaias	"Destin fireworks schedules, seasonal events and weather updates for boaters."

Rename the existing "Blog" category (ID 1) to "Crab Island & Boating" instead of deleting it. That keeps its ID and any links. VERIFY whether Rank Math "Strip Category Base" is on: if so, the category slug `blog` collides with the /blog/ page URL, which is one more reason to rename it. Delete the empty "Uncategorized" (ID 5) only if it isn't the default category.

7. Content plan (gaps found so far)

New post	Target keyword (vol / KD)	Links to
Things to Do in Destin, FL: A Local's List	things to do in destin (8,100 / 15)	Crab Island tours, dolphin cruise, sunset cruise, restaurants post
Destin Fireworks Schedule [Year]	destin fireworks (590 / 29), destin fireworks schedule (70)	Fireworks cruise `#fireworks`; update post 2192 instead if preferred
Destin Bachelorette Weekend Itinerary	destin bachelorette (70), bachelorette party destin fl (110)	/destin-bachelorette-party-boat/
Dolphins in Destin: When and Where to See Them	dolphin watching destin (50), swim with dolphins destin (720, answered honestly)	/destin-dolphin-cruise/

8. Technical fixes

Issue	Fix	Priority
Demo blocks + hot-linked images	Clear the page content (Gutenberg blocks) and rebuild in Elementor, or use an **Elementor Theme Builder → Archive** template for the Posts page with the H1, intro and Posts widgets. Check the Network tab for any request to radiustheme.com.	**High**
Show guide pages	Add a manual card section (Elementor Posts widget with Source = "Manual selection" of the 6 pages, or simple Icon Boxes).	**High**
Post cards	Each card: featured image (posts currently have no featured images per the SEO overview, VERIFY), title as H3, excerpt, date. Set featured images on all 8 posts. Those images also become the OG images.	**Medium**
Plugins	If The Post Grid isn't used anywhere else after the rebuild, deactivate it (and Advanced Post Block / Advanced Posts Listing if also unused). That's three overlapping post-listing plugins.	**Medium**
Schema	Rank Math: CollectionPage (default for the blog) + BreadcrumbList. Posts get BlogPosting with author and dates.	**Low**

9. Tracking

Item	Setup

Content grouping	GA4 content group by URL: Service pages / Crab Island guides / Blog posts / Spotlights. This shows which content type drives bookings.
Blog → booking	Path exploration from the blog and posts to Book Now. Key event attribution: "data-driven" to credit assisting posts.
Card clicks	`select_content` with `content_type` = guide / post and `item_id` = slug.
Partner traffic	Spotlight posts send clicks to partners. Track `partner_click` (outbound) and ask partners to link back, which gives this site local backlinks.

10. Changelog (implementation checklist)

#	Change	Where	Status
1	VERIFY which template renders /blog/	Live site	To do
2	**Demo Post Grid blocks and radiustheme.com images removed**	Page 2048 / Elementor	To do
3	H1 + intro; 4 topic sections; guide cards; CTA banner	Elementor / Theme Builder	To do
4	Categories restructured (4), descriptions written, posts reassigned; "Blog" renamed	Posts → Categories	To do
5	SEO title/meta/focus; page title "Destin Local Guide"	Rank Math	To do
6	Featured images for all 8 posts	Posts	To do
7	Unused post-grid plugins deactivated	Plugins	To do
8	4 new posts planned (Things to Do pillar first)	Content	To do
9	Content groups, card click and partner click tracking	GA4 / GTM	To do

Next page in queue: **Post: The Ultimate Front-Row Seat for the Destin Fireworks Cruise** (ID 2192).